We could say that Adam and Eve provided raw data to Candace. She then aggregated it into information and handed it over to Bob to turn the data into decisions and business value. Notice how you again can see a *pipeline* : a sequence of steps that turns the data into value. The pipeline has two steps for setting prices (Adam and Eve collect the data in their time sheets, and Candace does her magic by aggregating the data and making decisions based on it), and three steps for the shovel procurement with Bob (Adam and Eve produce data with their shovel forecasts, Candace aggregates the data, and Bob makes decisions based on it).

But, as we said previously, Candace is not happy with the situation. Profits are not very good. The shovel procurement seems to always be off: sometimes inventory seems to stack up, and other times Adam and Eve need to delay their work because they run out of shovels.

This year, after reading a book called *Data Mesh in Action*, Candace decides to experiment. She decides to *build the foundation for a data mesh,* as described in chapter 3 of the book. She uses knowledge from chapter 4 to define domain boundaries and give the ownership of data to her main shoveling domain owners—namely, Adam and Eve. That means the following:

- Candace stops collecting the times and instead asks Adam and Eve to record their times themselves in any way they see fit.
- Adam and Eve will set the pricing for their streets.

Then something interesting happens when Eve decides to increase prices on Oak Street and Adam decreases the prices on Pine Road. It turns out they simply know more about their neighborhoods than Candace does. On Oak Street the houses have long driveways, so Eve needs to charge more for shoveling snow. On Pine Road a local kid is shoveling snow cheaper, so to be competitive Adam needs to lower his prices. Figure 1.7 shows the decentralized data flow now taking place.